
BUYER TIPS
BUYING IN NC OR SC? CHECK THE MAP.
CHECK THE FLOOD MAP FIRST.
Look up the flood zone for any address
Know what your insurance does and doesn't cover
Here's what I'd check, step by step
BUYER TIPS
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THE MARKET

CHARLOTTE METRO, NC + SC

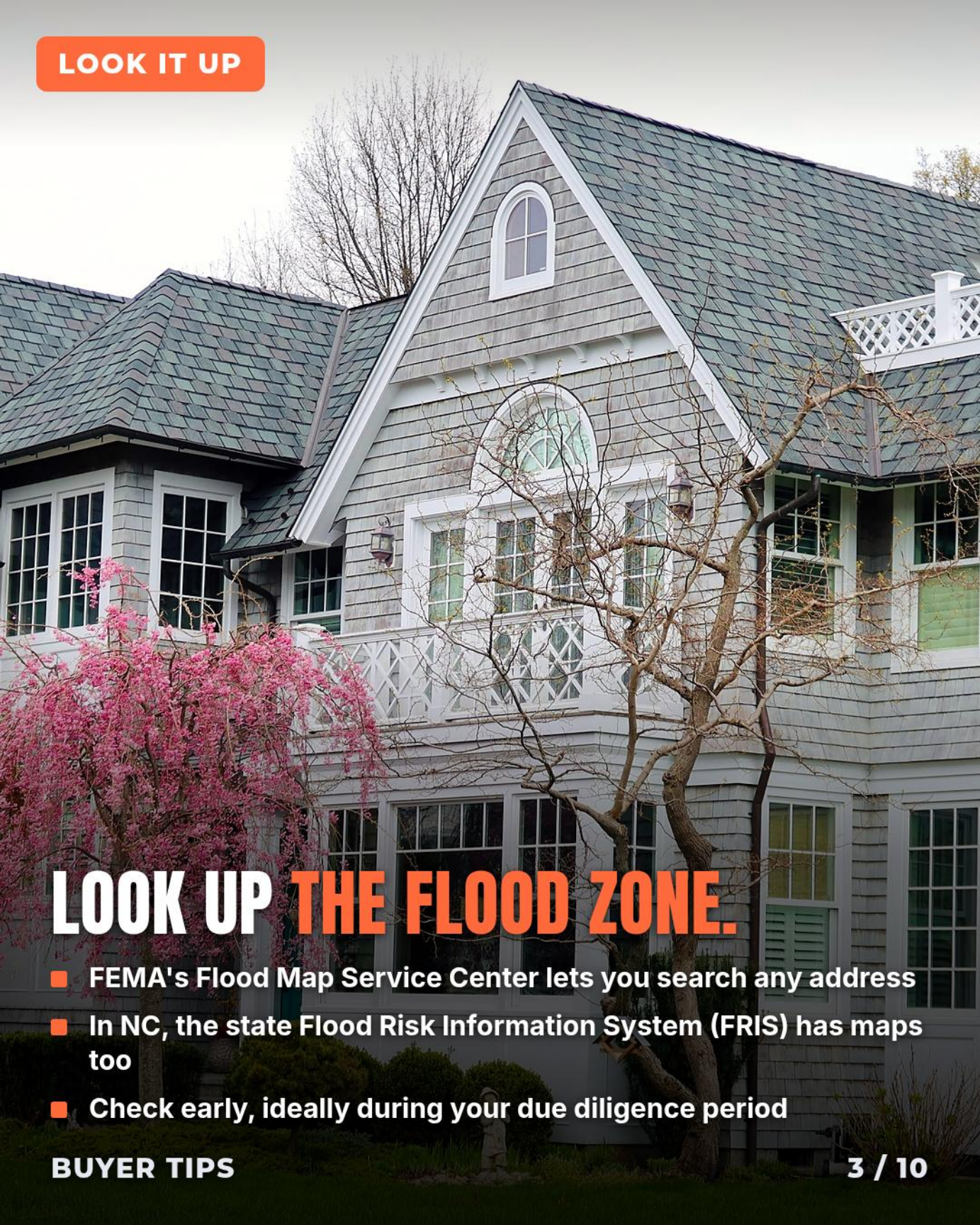
SEPTEMBER 2026.

MEDIAN LIST PRICE	$424,950	−3.1% YoY
ACTIVE LISTINGS	11,182	+10.3% YoY
MEDIAN DAYS ON MARKET	64	+10.3% YoY
PRICE-REDUCED SHARE	26.2%	+0.7 pts YoY

More homes to choose from and more time on the market. Use that time to check each home's flood risk.

Source: Realtor.com Economic Research, Charlotte-Concord-Gastonia, NC-SC metro, September 2026

LOOK IT UP



LOOK UP THE FLOOD ZONE.

- FEMA's Flood Map Service Center lets you search any address
- In NC, the state Flood Risk Information System (FRIS) has maps too
- Check early, ideally during your due diligence period



KNOW WHAT THE LETTERS MEAN.

- Zones starting with A or V are high-risk areas
- Shaded Zone X is moderate risk; unshaded Zone X is minimal
- FEMA notes floods can happen anywhere, even in lower-risk zones


YOUR LENDER
HIGH-RISK ZONE? ASK YOUR LENDER.
With a government-backed mortgage, flood insurance is required in a high-risk zone
Some lenders require it in other areas too
Ask early so the cost is part of your monthly budget
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YOUR POLICY



HOMEOWNERS INSURANCE ISN'T FLOOD INSURANCE.

- Most homeowners policies don't cover flood damage
- Flood coverage is a separate policy, through the NFIP or a private insurer
- Ask a licensed insurance agent to quote the home you're considering



TIMING

MIND THE 30-DAY WAIT.

- A new NFIP policy usually takes effect 30 days after purchase
- There's no wait when it's bought while making a new mortgage
- Line it up with your lender and agent before closing



NC DISCLOSURES

READ THE FLOOD QUESTIONS.

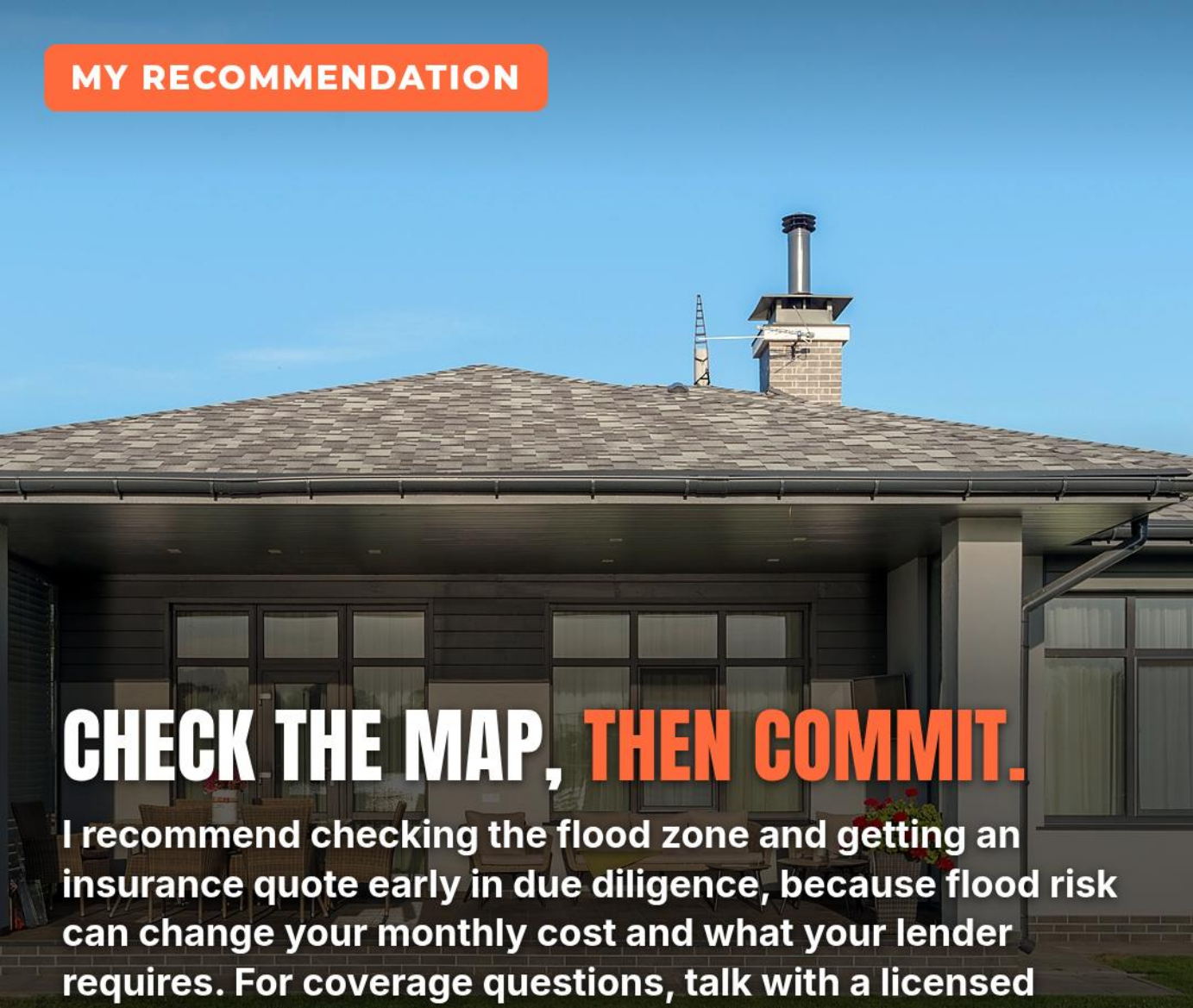
- NC's disclosure statement (REC 4.22) asks about flood zones, past flood damage and claims
- It also asks about current flood insurance and elevation certificates
- A "No" means the owner has no actual knowledge, not that there's no problem

ASK FOR IT

ASK FOR THE PAPERWORK.

- Ask if there's an elevation certificate for the home
- In NC, the disclosure form notes an existing flood policy may be assignable to a buyer
- In SC, ask the seller directly and check the FEMA map yourself

MY RECOMMENDATION



CHECK THE MAP, THEN COMMIT.

I recommend checking the flood zone and getting an insurance quote early in due diligence, because flood risk can change your monthly cost and what your lender requires. For coverage questions, talk with a licensed insurance agent.

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